



1000-18 (C&E Branch Secretariat)

July 2015

Distribution List

COMMUNICATIONS AND ELECTRONICS
BRANCH ADVISORY COMMITTEE MEETING
MINUTES – THURS, 09 APRIL 2015, ADM(IM) CONF RM (8CBS S001)

RECORD OF DISCUSSIONS			
In Attendance	Rank	Name	Organization
Chairman	MGen	D.G. Neasmith	Branch Leader
Co-Chairman	Col	P.C. Sabourin	Branch Advisor
Members	BGen (ret'd)	W.S. Richard	Col-Cmdt
	BGen	J.J.M. Girard	DGMS
	BGen	P. Rutherford	CENTCOM DJ5
	Col	S.N. Lew	CELE (Air) Trade Advisor Rep
	Col	A.H.J. Schwab	DGIMO Rep
	LCol	J.P.G. Blais-Parent	Dir Sigs Rep
	LCol	D.J. Lambert	Cmdt CFSCE
	Maj	G.R. Sarsons	CANSOFCOM Rep
	CWO	M.C. Boislard	Branch CWO
	CWO	J.M.R. Guenette	SCWO CFSCE
	CWO	M.R.C. Ouellet	CFIOG Gp CWO Rep
CI	Maj	E.M. Esselaar	CI CFSCE
Branch Adj	Maj	R.R. Kollman	C&E Branch Adj
EA COS IM	Maj	J.A. Roper	EA COS (IM)
Secretary	2Lt	M.C. Kim	C&E Branch Asst Adj
Branch AA	MCpl	N.V.M. Larin	Chief Clerk
Absent	BGen	G.D. Loos	Comd JTFN
	BGen	R.G. Mazzolin	DGIMO
	BGen	F.J. Allen	VCDS DGDS
	Col	T.S. Sullivan	Dir RCCS
	Col	J.C.F. Beaupre	CELE (Air) Trade Advisor
	Col	S.M. Moritsugu	Comd CFIOG
	LCol	I.R. Marchand	CANSOFCOM J6
	CWO	N.J. Dubois	ATIS Tech Trade Advisor
	CWO	M.R. Bastien	CFIOG Gp CWO
	CWO	D.A. MacIsaak	CFINTCOM Comd Chief

ITEM	DISCUSSION & ACTION ITEM(S)	ACTION
I	<u>Introductory Remarks</u> 1. Opening Remarks. a. Welcomed all members to the BAC.	
II	<u>Branch Update</u> 1. The intent of the branch update is to provide information based on previous minutes with an emphasis on budget. 2. The branch funds come from C&E Museum Foundation. The museum draws in around \$110K/year through military member pay allotment (ref P070) and redirects \$20K to the Branch Fund annually. 3. Col Arthur Child fund was discussed. a. There is a balance of \$52,428.00 in the savings account and \$5,852.00 in the chequing account. These funds had been used for a variety of purposes including honorary funds, paying for transit airfield costs, penalties, etc. b. Action Item #1: Proposal to use the Col Arthur Child Fund to provide for distress relief. Also a proposal to make the funds available for not only serving members but also the retired community. Currently, distress funds are being provided by the C&E Branch Fund. This proposal was approved by the BAC. c. MGen Neasmith explained the need to keep in mind the intent of the Col Arthur Child Fund. In the past, this has been used as a “shock absorber”. This will need some way of replenishment as funds will be used up over time to support those in distress. d. BGen Richard (Ret'd) explained that the purpose of the Col Arthur Child Fund is 2-fold. First is for supporting heritage projects, and second is to support the morale, esprit de corps, and distress of the people. e. Over time there will be a need to look at fundraising for not only the Col Arthur Child Fund but other funds such as the Museum Fund so that there's no risk for depletion. f. LCol Blais-Parent inquired about the impact if we will increase the scope of the funds to include the retired community. This will have to be looked into.	Col Sabourin Info (Branch Advisor) Maj Kollman Info (Branch Adj) Col Sabourin (Branch Advisor)

	g. Col Sabourin suggested that we can invest a portion of the money in a secure investment to also increase funds. This will have to be looked into as doing this will limit flexibility on a portion of the funds. [Chequing account is currently being used for quick money access. Savings account is currently being invested: 12.5K in 3 month term investment + 12.5K in 18 month term investments as a well-recognized "Ladder Strategy"]. 4. The Int Branch's request to identify CFB Kingston as their Homestation was discussed. a. BAC was approached by the Base Comd of CFB Kingston with a courtesy request to affiliate the Int Branch with CFB Kingston as their Home Station. Survey on CMCEN asking about Int Corps' affiliation with CFB Kingston as their Home Station had very positive results (75% - 80% voted yes). However, there are concerns with the reallocation of rooms at the VOM. A proposal was made to designate the Clinton Room to the Int Branch and use Mercury Room to represent the C&E Branch. b. Col Sabourin indicated that Kingston is very Army centric and the Clinton room is the only Air Force centric room on the base. There are concerns in the Air Force about losing this room as it is a part of their heritage. Perhaps it's better to form a committee to explore how to best represent all elements. c. LCol Lambert mentioned that there is no room that represents the entire branch. A more in depth discussion about this proposal would be a good idea upon formation of a committee. d. Col Schwab mentioned that if the Int Corps is serious about demonstrating that they want to affiliate with Kingston as their Home Station, they would likely build a room for the Int Branch by proposing to expand the VOM. e. BGen Girard mentioned that the plan stated above is what they will do in the long term. Acquiring the Clinton Room is a short term solution. Furthermore, the Int Branch is a small branch (approx. 1000 mbrs) and has no abundance of money to facilitate building a separate room for themselves at this time. g. Action Item #2: MGen Neasmith decided that as a Branch, we will extend a warm welcome to the Int Branch. He proposed to pull together a committee with various representation under the Home Station PMC. The retired community should also be involved in this (the Col-Cmdt's aide was requested). A Committee will look at the best short and long term solutions (eg. Short term: give the Clinton Room to the Int Branch. Long term: build an annex to the mess). Anything we do in the VOM as a branch should represent the 4 elements of the branch (ie. Army,	BGen Richard (Ret'd) (Col Cmdt)
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	Air, Comm Research, SOF). The WO's and Sgt's mess should also be considered in the planning process. 5. The Branch Fund was discussed. a. Col Sabourin indicated that there is money available for unit activities and the funds are underutilized. Col Sabourin also indicated that the intent of the funds is not for members to borrow money and subsequently generate profit for the Branch through their activities, but to request funding to aide in running unit activities and offsetting costs. It is important for branch leaders to make their respective units aware that if they are running unit activities, they can request funding. 6. C&E Branch reservist positions were discussed. CWO Boislard indicated that the branch has 4 reservists positions (2x Class B, 2x Class A). Class B positions are currently filled by MCpl Larin and the other position is on loan to COS IM for 2 years. Class A positions are filled by WO Gagnon, and the other position will be used to hire a Media Manager to promote web presence (eg. DWAN Intranet, CMCEN.ca). 7. CWO Boislard indicated that the branch intranet website has been stood down as of 28 Mar 15, and in place the branch internet website has been stood up. 8. CWO Boislard indicated that after talking with public affairs personnel, there was a recommendation to continue the presence of the branch on the government internet website. There was also a recommendation to re-launch the branch intranet website. 9. Nominations are being requested for bursaries allocated for post secondary education in support of family members of serving and retired personnel of the branch (Secretarial note: 12 apps rx'd) . 10. 6 May 15 is the annual NCR C&E All Ranks Mess Dinner. 11. Col Cmdt and Br Chief have been invited and will be attending the 2015 New Brunswick Signals Association Reunion taking place from 24 - 26 Apr 15 in Gagetown, NB. 12. MGen Neasmith emphasized the importance of informing branch members about the availability of the Branch Fund.	Col Sabourin Info (Branch Advisor) CWO Boislard Info (Branch Chief)
III	<u>Col Cmdt Update</u> 1. Action Item #3: Col Cmdt proposed to stand up the General Ramsey Withers Heritage Memorial Fund to recognize the contributions made by General Withers as he was the only member in the branch who held the CDS position. The fund would be	BGen Richard (Ret'd) (Col Cmdt)

	focused on supporting areas of his major interests which included the preservation of heritage and history. a. There are already some difficulties in managing the variety of funds that exist. Introducing another fund would only add to the challenges of managing the complexity. Col Cmdt indicated that the fund can solicit contributions. MGen Neasmith agreed with the Col Cmdt stating that this fund could provide another raison d'être to facilitate more contributions. b. MGen Neasmith indicated that the proposal is fully supported by the BAC, and that he will work with the Col Cmdt to stand up this fund. 2. Action Item #4: Col Cmdt proposed to stand up the C&E Heritage Philanthropy Leadership Award to recognize those who are significant philanthropic donors in support of the preservation of the C&E Heritage; namely W.J. Henderson and Col Gerry Coady among others. a. BAC has supported the proposal made by the Col-Cmdt. The W.J. Henderson Foundation will be recognized through this award.	BGen Richard (Ret'd) (Col Cmdt)
IV	<u>Update on the Home Station & Branch Activities</u> 1. Discussion of CMCEN took place. This website was stood up because of the need to bring together the serving and retired communities (the serving and retired C&E community has approximately 50K members, of which 7500 are serving). As there's a large retired population, there needs to be a way to reach out and connect all members of the community. a. C&E Association was still on the Industry Canada corporate books, and as we were developing CMCEN, we were going to be disbanded unless our corporate documents were updated. Incorporation of CMCEN is still unknown, but we don't want to lose our position within Industry Canada. There is an implementation committee that's been working since the briefing at C&E Week 2014. b. Line Of Operations (LOO) for the CMCEN on the new CMCEN.ca website was discussed: LOO 1: Enhance effectiveness of Canadian military communications (Focus is with serving and retired members). LOO 2: Looking after members; morale and welfare (Focus is with serving and retired members). LOO 3: Promoting the Heritage Fund. LOO 4 (center of gravity): Connect the C&E community (Focus is with serving and retired members).	BGen Richard (Ret'd) Info (Col Cmdt)

	Jun 15, the CFJSR CoC is on the 24th of June, the CFSCE CoC on the 25th. Also on the 25th, will be the change of Branch Leader and the Semaphore to Satellite Book display. i. C&E Week, 21-24 Oct 15. Draft timetable was discussed and endorsed in general principal. (1). MGen Neasmith wants to emphasize the use of CMCEN.ca for C&E Week. (2). MGen Neasmith would like to see more troops attend the C&E Week activities voluntarily, instead of being obligated by the CoC to attend. LCol Lambert indicated that greater encouragement from the CoC will augment voluntary participation. j. Update with the museum. (1). Expansion of museum has been completed on time and within budget. (2). Transfer of museum staff less Museum Director has been completed and all staff are under NPP/NPF. (3). The transfer to bring the museum kit shop to be under NPP/NPF is still ongoing. (4). C&E Heritage Committee initial meeting took place on 18 Feb 15. k. Action Item #8: (6900) Marketing problem for Semaphore to Satellite was discussed. Solution recommended for this is to decentralize inventory and challenge Branch command teams to distribute books. There are approximately 1500 books in stock. l. Secretarial Note #2: Branch Advisor visited 17 Wing and learned that a lot of people (including the senior staff) were not aware or did not have a copy of the S2S book. They would be happy to get copies of the book.	MGen Neasmith (Branch Leader)
V	<u>Proposal to Change Mess Dress</u> 1. Action Item #9: Proposal to reintroduce spurs in the mess kit. Spurs have been part of the Corps heritage and if it's introduced, it would only be introduced as an option for members to get. Armoured Corps will be engaged for participation in this.	LCol Blais-Parent (Dir RCCS Rep)
VI	<u>Impact Upon CAF Due to Cyber Growth</u> 1. Col Sabourin discussed plans of growing the cyber force. CFD plan	

	is to increase the force by 400 members which includes civilians and military. a. There is an issue with filling the newly created cyber positions, because members are being sourced from existing trades that are already stressed. In order to mitigate and normalize the creation of the new positions, CMP needs to be aware that we are growing the cyber force and that we need to generate more tradesmen. b. Action Item #10: MGen Neasmith will engage CMP as the Branch Leader. He will need in writing, the specifics of the facts of what we're growing, where and how so that he can formalize the request. We will also have to request adjustment to the SIP to account for the growth of the cyber force. c. LCol Blais-Parent indicated that until we positively know what roles and responsibilities cyber will take on, it will be difficult to introduce this to recruiting. d. MGen Neasmith indicated that the challenge of recruitment is that cyber has no distinct element that's associated with it yet. For this reason, recruitment for officers and tradesmen need to take place outside the core Army. e. Col Sabourin further elaborated that the EM spectrum will become a contested space in the future and if there's no investment in cyber now, it will become more difficult to achieve the desired effects in warfare in the future. f. Action Item #11: Col Sabourin mentioned that one of the short term action items is to muster personnel from other trades with the required technical background to work in cyber. h. Col Schwab also proposed as a short term solution to recover personnel that are on loan right now (eg. mbrs to SSC). MGen Neasmith indicated that this will be the next step after CMP is approached, as a means to reinvest personnel into areas that are of higher priority. k. LCol Lambert mentioned that there is also a problem with training at the school. This problem stems from the fact that the school is lacking personnel to train members into the branch (the budget is not the problem). He indicated that if this problem is not addressed now, it will become a greater problem in the future in which case it will become a branch responsibility to acquire personnel. l. LCol Blais-Parent indicated there's no added value in growing the SIP. The reason for this is because historically we have fallen short of the SIP. The chokepoint is not training, the chokepoint is	Col Sabourin Info (Branch Advisor) MGen Neasmith (Branch Leader) Col Sabourin (Branch Advisor) LCol Lambert Info (Cmndt CFSCE) LCol Blais-Parent Info (Dir RCCS Rep)
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	the recruitment of members. There has already been action taken to facilitate the intake of more personnel (eg. modifying the SIP) as well modifying the entry standards. There has been an attraction team in the past that was successful in recruiting more ACISS personnel. Perhaps this idea should be used to attract more personnel into other trades that are lacking. m. LCol Blais-Parent also indicated that it would be very helpful to provide the career managers at DGMC with the information indicating areas where risk should or should not be taken. This was supported by MGen Neasmith. n. LCol Blais-Parent proposed as another mitigation, to lift the heavy restrictions in place and use reservists to fill trades that are in the red. This temporary solution can go a long way. MGen Neasmith supports this as well, and will factor it into this representation to CMP.	
VII	<u>Round Table - Updates/Issues</u> 1. Proposal to introduce Begone Dull Care as a corps march. a. Col Sabourin mentioned that this action destabilizes the unity of the Branch. b. LCol Blais-Parent mentioned that the concept would be to have a 'strong corps in a strong branch'. MGen Neasmith supports this concept, but noted that the Mercury March should stay senior to Begone Dull Care. If the Air Force would like to propose a march like Begone Dull Care, this can be initiated as well. c. As playing 'devil's advocate', Col Sabourin mentioned that a branch is only as strong as its weakest link. Many Air Force members don't feel that they are well represented in the branch and this initiative is another distinction that separates the two elements. We have to be careful in all these initiatives. d. Action Item #12: MGen Neasmith mentioned that Begone Dull Care needs to be preserved because it is important to the history of the RCCS. 2. CWO MacIsaak proposed to allow the gold braid on the CWOs mess kit, which is in line with other army chief's dress. Survey was done and the majority of the chiefs are in favor of the gold braid. 3. LCol Blais-Parent indicated that the G6 wanted to send a letter to provide an update on spec pay. There will be an attempt to remove the pay freeze that has been put in place. 4. Col Lew indicated that the BCAOC and ATIS courses are being	LCol Blais-Parent (Dir RCCS Rep) LCol Blais-Parent Info (Dir RCCS Rep) Col Lew Info (Dir

	overhauled right now and are zero loading them for a year. On behalf of CELE council, LCol Lambert and staff were thanked for their work at CFSCE for revamping the courses. 5. Two members from SOFCOM will be filling new cyber positions. MGen Neasmith recommended SOFCOM to coordinate with Dr. Scott Knight at RMC to inquire about the cyber program in acquiring the necessary technical skills to work in cyber. 6. Col Schwab on behalf of BGen Mazzolin emphasized the importance of investing more time and thought into the HR problem in cyber. 7. 100 years celebrations are coming up so it'll be important not skip over these events as we have many C&E Branch veterans that took part of many campaigns, such as Somme - 1916 and Vimy Ridge - 1917. 8. CFNetOps course will take place this fall. Everyone is encouraged to find candidates for this.	Air C&E Rep) Maj Sarsons Info (CANSOFCOM Rep) Col Schwab Info (DGIMO Rep)
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Prepared by: Maj Ron Kollman, 2Lt MinChul Kim
C&E Branch Adjt, C&E Branch Asst Adjt

Reviewed by Col Patrice Sabourin
C&E Branch Advisor

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BAC Membership